

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10
♥ 10 9 6 4
♦ 10 9 5
♣ K Q 8 5

♠ A Q 7 5 3

♥ K Q

♦ A 8 7 6

♣ 9 4



♠ 9 8

♥ A 7 3 2

♦ Q J 4

♣ J 10 7 3

♠ K 6 4 2

♥ J 8 5

♦ K 3 2

♣ A 6 2

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 16 points NORTH should open 1♠.

SOUTH has 11 points and four ♠s. So even though he has a balanced hand, he jumps to 3♠, a Limit Raise.

NORTH adds: her 16 plus SOUTH's 11/12 equals a game, 4♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♣J			

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 2
 ♥ Q 2
 ♦ Q J 10 9 4 3
 ♣ 7 4 2

♠ A K Q 7

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ Q 9 5



♠ 5 3

♥ K J 10 9 8 5

♦ 7

♣ A 10 8 6

♠ J 10 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 3

SOUTH has the type of 5-card Major hand that many players would open 1NT. He has 17 points with most of them OUTSIDE the Major suit. But, many others would disagree so for this Deal SOUTH will open 1♠.

NORTH has 11 points and excellent (is that strong enough?) ♠ support. So she naturally makes a Limit Raise of 3♠.

SOUTH adds the points and ignores the fact that his ♠ suit is Jack high. He bids 4♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ Q			

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 3
♥ 7 4
♦ 9 4 2
♣ J 10 8 3

♠ K 5

♥ Q J 10 8 3

♦ K Q J

♣ 9 6 2



♠ 10 8 7 2
♥ A 6
♦ A 10 8
♣ Q 7 5 4

♠ A 6 4

♥ K 9 5 2

♦ 7 6 5 3

♣ A K

NORTH has a minimum 1♥ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps.

SOUTH also has opening hand strength, 14 points for him. He also has four of NORTH's ♥s. He applies the "He who knows, goes" principle and bids 4♥.

IMPORTANT NOTE: Most experienced bridge pairs would not bid the hand quite this way, although they would arrive at the same contract. See some of the other BakerBridge lessons for more details.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♠7

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 3
♥ 9 7 6 3 2
♦ 8 2
♣ A K Q 2

♠ K Q 9 2

♥ Q J

♦ Q 7 6 4

♣ J 8 4



♠ 5

♥ 10 8 4

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ 10 7 6 5 3

♠ A J 10 8 7 4

♥ A K 5

♦ A K 3

♣ 9

SOUTH has a powerful hand (21 points) with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1 ♠.

NORTH has an 11-point Limit Raise with four trumps. She jumps to 3 ♠.

SOUTH now knows that the partnership holds at least 32 points, perhaps 33. Since he can see that the opponents have no way to win the first two tricks he decides to bid the slam, 6 ♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q
♥ K J 8 4
♦ Q J 10 6 2
♣ Q 7 2

♠ A 7 6 5 2

♥ 7 6

♦ A 8 3

♣ A J 4



♠ K 8
♥ Q 10 9 2
♦ K 7 5 4
♣ 10 9 5

♠ J 10 9 4 3

♥ A 5 3

♦ 9

♣ K 8 6 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ 10

NORTH has 14 points and opens 1 ♠, her 5-card Major.

SOUTH could bid 3 ♠, a Limit Raise with his 11 points. But it is often a good idea, when you have five of the Major suit that partner opened with, to just go ahead and bid the game. So South should bid 4 ♠ here.

See the NOTE in Deal 13. When you use weaker 5-card support hands for your jump to game, you need to find another way to describe your opening-hand-strength type hands.